Chapter 7 - Superposition of Quasi-Parallel Plane Waves

- ↳ more complicated waves can be built → superposition
- ↳ phase velocity vs. group velocity
- ↳ Fourier theory
- ↳ dispersion

$$\vec{E}(\vec{r},t) = \sum_j \vec{E}_j e^{i(\vec{k}_j \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_j t)}$$

amplitude + phase

$$\vec{B}(\vec{r},t) = \sum_j \vec{B}_j e^{i(\vec{k}_j \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_j t)}$$

amplitude + phase

$$= \sum_j \frac{\vec{k}_j \times \vec{E}_j}{\omega_j} e^{i(\vec{k}_j \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_j t)}$$

$$\vec{S}(\vec{r},t) = \mathrm{Re}\{\vec{E}(\vec{r},t)\} \cdot \frac{\mathrm{Re}\{\vec{B}(\vec{r},t)\}}{\mu_0}$$

time average to exclude many short variations

limit to k's that point mostly in the same direction

$$\langle \vec{S} \rangle = I = \frac{n\epsilon_0 c}{2} \cdot \vec{E}(\vec{r},t) \cdot \vec{E}^*(\vec{r},t)$$

Group velocity vs. Phase Velocity

$$E_1 = \vec{E}_0 e^{i(\vec{k}_1 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_1 t)} \qquad E_2 = \vec{E}_0 e^{i(\vec{k}_2 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_2 t)}$$

$$v_{p1} = \frac{\omega_1}{k_1} \qquad v_{p2} = \frac{\omega_2}{k_2}$$

$$I(\vec{r},t) = \frac{n\epsilon_0 c}{2} \vec{E}_0 \cdot \vec{E}_0^* \left[e^{i(\vec{k}_1 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_1 t)} + e^{i(\vec{k}_2 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_2 t)} \right] \left[e^{-i(\vec{k}_1 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_1 t)} + e^{-i(\vec{k}_2 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_2 t)} \right]$$

$$I(\vec{r},t) = \frac{n\epsilon_0 c}{2} \vec{E}_0 \cdot \vec{E}_0^* \left(2 + e^{i(\vec{k}_1 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_1 t - \vec{k}_2 \cdot \vec{r} + \omega_2 t)} + e^{i(\vec{k}_2 \cdot \vec{r} - \omega_2 t - \vec{k}_1 \cdot \vec{r} + \omega_1 t)} \right)$$

$$I(\vec{r},t) = \frac{n\epsilon_0 c}{2} \vec{E}_0 \cdot \vec{E}_0^* \left(2 + e^{i[(\vec{k}_2 - \vec{k}_1) \cdot \vec{r} - (\omega_2 - \omega_1) t]} + e^{-i[(\vec{k}_2 - \vec{k}_1) \cdot \vec{r} - (\omega_2 - \omega_1) t]} \right)$$

$$\cos(x) = \frac{e^{x} + e^{-x}}{2}$$

$$\sin(x) = \frac{e^{x} - e^{-x}}{2i}$$

$$I(\vec{r},t) = n\epsilon_0 c \cdot \vec{E}_0 \cdot \vec{E}_0^{*}\left(1 + \cos\left[\underbrace{(\vec{k}_2 - \vec{k}_1)}_{\Delta\vec{k}} \cdot \vec{r} - \underbrace{(\omega_2 - \omega_1)}_{\Delta\omega} t\right]\right)$$

$$v_p = \frac{\bar{\omega}}{\bar{k}}$$

$$\bar{\omega} = \frac{\omega_1 + \omega_2}{2}$$

average

$$\bar{k} = \frac{k_1 + k_2}{2}$$

$$v_g = \frac{\Delta\omega}{\Delta k} = \frac{d\omega}{dk}$$

for the jupyter example

$$v_p = \frac{\omega_1 + \omega_2}{k_1 + k_2} = \frac{1+2}{2+0.2} = \frac{3}{2.2}$$

$$v_p = 1.4$$

$$v_g = \frac{2-1}{2-0.2} = \frac{1}{1.8} = 0.6$$

$$v_g = 0.6$$

Example 7.1

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Determine the phase velocity and group velocity for the superposition of two plane waves in a plasma (see P2.7).

$$n_p(\omega) = \sqrt{1 - \frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}} \qquad \omega > \omega_p \quad \text{so} \quad n_p(\omega) < 1$$

$$\frac{c}{n} = v = \frac{\omega}{k} \Rightarrow k = \frac{\omega \cdot n_p(\omega)}{c} \Rightarrow k_1 = \frac{\omega_1 \cdot n_p(\omega_1)}{c} \qquad k_2 = \frac{\omega_2 \cdot n_p(\omega_2)}{c}$$

$$v_p = \frac{\omega_2 + \omega_1}{k_2 + k_1} = \frac{\omega_2 + \omega_1}{\frac{\omega_2 n_p(\omega_2)}{c} + \frac{\omega_1 n_p(\omega_1)}{c}}$$

if ω_2 is nearly ω_1

$n_p(\omega_1) \approx n_p(\omega_2)$

$$v_p = \frac{c}{n_p(\omega)}$$

$$v_g = \frac{\Delta\omega}{\Delta k} \approx \frac{d\omega}{dk} = \left(\frac{dk}{d\omega}\right)^{-1} = \left[\frac{d}{d\omega}\left(\frac{\omega \cdot n_p(\omega)}{c}\right)\right]^{-1} = \left[\frac{d}{d\omega}\left(\frac{\omega}{c} \cdot \left(1 - \frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2}\right)\right]^{-1}$$

physicist math!

$$= c\left[\underbrace{\frac{d}{d\omega}\left(\omega\left(1 - \frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2}\right)}_{1}\right]^{-1}$$

$$\downarrow$$

$$\left(1-\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2} + \cancel{\omega}\cdot\left(+\frac{1}{\cancel{2}}\right)\left(1-\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{-1/2}\cdot(\cancel{+2})\,\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^{\cancel{3}\,2}}$$

$$c\left[\left(1-\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2}\frac{\left(1-\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2}+\frac{\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}}{\left(1-\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2}}}{\left(1-\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2}}\right]^{-1}$$

← get common denom

$$= c\,\frac{\left(1-\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}\right)^{1/2}}{1-\cancel{\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}}+\cancel{\frac{\omega_p^2}{\omega^2}}}$$

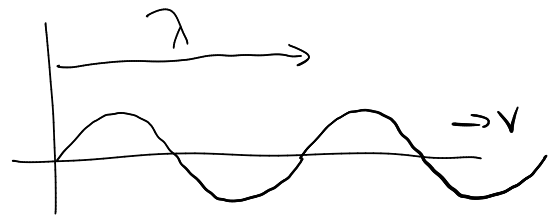
← spent my inverse power

$$V_g = c\cdot n_p(\omega)$$

Fourier Analysis

periodic waves → a wave that repeats itself over time

harmonic waves → sin/cosine wave



$$\cos\alpha + \cos\beta \neq \cos\gamma$$

$$= 2\cos\left(\frac{\alpha+\beta}{2}\right)\cos\left(\frac{\alpha-\beta}{2}\right)$$

$$f(t) = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_m \cdot \cos(m \cdot w \cdot t) + \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} b_m \sin(mwt)$$

} Fourier series

complete basis set

↳ Bessel Functions

↳ Hermite polynomials

↳ Legendre polynomials

↳ Laguerre polynomials

$$f(t) = \frac{a_0}{2} + \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} a_m \cos(mwt) + \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} b_m \sin(mwt)$$

$$\int_0^T f(t)\,dt = \underbrace{\int_0^T \frac{a_0}{2}\,dt}_{\frac{a_0 T}{2}} + \underbrace{\int_0^T \text{all the sines/cosines } dt}_{=0 \text{ if we are clever about } T}$$

We "know" what $f(t)$ is

we make $w = \frac{2\pi}{T} \rightarrow T = \frac{2\pi}{w}$

$$a_0 = \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T f(t)\,dt \quad \checkmark$$

Now for the infinitely many others:

$$\int_0^T f(t)\cos(n\omega t)\,dt = \underbrace{\int_0^T \frac{a_0}{2}\cos(n\omega t)\,dt}_{=0} + \underbrace{\sum_{m=1}^{\infty}\int_0^T a_m \cos(m\omega t)\cos(n\omega t)\,dt}_{\substack{=0 \quad m\neq n \\ =\frac{T}{2} \quad m=n}} + \underbrace{\sum_{m=1}^{\infty}\int_0^T b_m \sin(m\omega t)\cdot\cos(n\omega t)\,dt}_{=0}$$

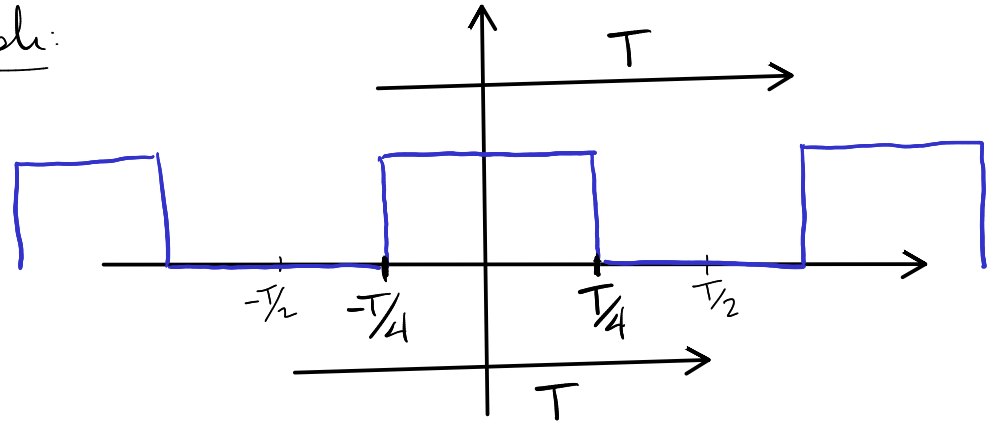
$$\int_0^T f(t)\cos(n\omega t)\,dt = \frac{T}{2}a_n$$

$$* \quad a_n = \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T f(t)\cdot\cos(n\omega t)\,dt$$

also I can do a similar thing to find b_n

$$* \quad b_n = \frac{2}{T}\int_0^T f(t)\cdot\sin(n\omega t)\,dt$$

Example:



$$f(t) = \begin{cases} 0 & -T/2 < t < -T/4 \\ 1 & -T/4 < t < +T/4 \\ 0 & T/4 < t < +T/2 \end{cases}$$

$$a_0 = \frac{2}{T}\int_{-T/2}^{+T/2} f(t)\,dt = \frac{2}{T}\underbrace{\int_{-T/4}^{+T/4} 1\,dt}_{t\Big|_{-T/4}^{+T/4}}$$

$$= \frac{2}{T}\left[\frac{T}{4} + \left(+\frac{T}{4}\right)\right]$$

$$= \frac{2}{T}\cdot\frac{T}{2}$$

$$= 1$$

$a_n =$

$b_n =$